CompanyFlow Employee Handbook

Version 2026.2 — effective 1 September 2026. Owner: Human Resources (hr@companyflow.example).

> Sample handbook written for testing the CompanyFlow HR assistant. CompanyFlow is a fictional company. These policies are not legal advice and do not describe any real employer.

1. Introduction and Scope

1.1 Who this handbook applies to

This handbook applies to all full-time and part-time employees of CompanyFlow in Egypt, including employees on probation. Contractors and interns follow their own agreements unless a section says otherwise.

1.2 How to get help

If something is unclear, ask the HR Policy Assistant in the CompanyFlow portal or contact Human Resources at hr@companyflow.example (extension 1200). The HR helpdesk is open Sunday to Thursday, 9:00 to 17:00 Cairo time.

2. Working Hours and Attendance

2.1 Standard working week

The working week is Sunday to Thursday. Standard hours are 9:00 to 17:00 with a one-hour lunch break (40 hours per week).

2.2 Flexible hours

Employees may start between 8:00 and 10:00 and finish eight hours later. Core hours, when everyone must be available, are 10:00 to 15:00.

2.3 Ramadan working hours

During the holy month of Ramadan the working day is reduced to 6 hours (10:00 to 16:00) with no reduction in pay.

2.4 Shift-based teams

Security Operations, Customer Operations and IT Services work rotating shifts. Night shifts (22:00 to 06:00) receive a night-shift allowance of 15% of the daily basic salary.

2.5 Lateness and absence

Notify your manager before 10:00 if you will be absent. Three unreported absences in a calendar year are a disciplinary matter.

3. Leave Policy

3.1 Annual leave

Employees receive 21 working days of paid annual leave per year after completing their first full year of service. During the first year, employees receive 15 working days, which can be used after completing the 3-month probation period. Employees with 10 or more years of service, or aged 50 or above, receive 30 working days.

3.2 Carry-over of annual leave

Up to 7 unused annual leave days can be carried over to the next year and must be used by 31 March. Days above 7 are lost unless the manager and HR approved the carry-over in writing for business reasons.

3.3 Requesting leave

Request annual leave in the HR portal at least 5 working days in advance (2 days for a single day). Your manager approves or rejects within 2 working days.

3.4 Casual (emergency) leave

Up to 6 days per year of the annual leave balance can be taken as casual leave without advance notice, with a maximum of 2 consecutive days each time. Inform your manager the same morning.

3.5 Sick leave

Sick leave is paid. A medical certificate is required for absences longer than 2 consecutive days. Long-term sick leave follows the social insurance rules and is coordinated by HR.

3.6 Maternity leave

Employees are entitled to 4 months of fully paid maternity leave. Employees returning from maternity leave may work reduced hours (one hour less per day) for 12 months to care for the child.

3.7 Paternity leave

Employees are entitled to 5 working days of fully paid paternity leave, to be taken within 2 months of the child's birth.

3.8 Bereavement leave

Employees receive 3 paid days of bereavement leave for the death of an immediate family member (parent, spouse, child, sibling).

3.9 Marriage leave

Employees receive 5 paid working days of marriage leave, once during their employment.

3.10 Pilgrimage leave

Employees with at least 5 years of service may take up to one month of paid pilgrimage leave, once during their employment.

3.11 Exam and study leave

Employees studying for an approved degree or certification receive paid study leave for exam days plus one preparation day per exam.

4. Public Holidays

CompanyFlow observes the official public holidays announced by the Egyptian government. Employees required to work on a public holiday receive a compensatory day off within 30 days or double pay for that day, as agreed with the manager.

5. Compensation and Payroll

5.1 Pay date

Salaries are paid monthly by bank transfer on the 25th of each month. If the 25th falls on a Friday, Saturday or public holiday, salaries are paid on the last working day before it.

5.2 Payslips

Payslips are available in the HR portal on pay day. Report any payroll error to payroll@companyflow.example within 10 days.

5.3 Overtime

Overtime must be approved by the manager in advance. Daytime overtime is paid at 1.35 times the hourly rate; night overtime at 1.70 times. Employees at manager level and above are not eligible for overtime pay.

5.4 Annual salary review

Salaries are reviewed once a year in January, based on performance review results and market data.

6. Benefits

6.1 Medical insurance

All employees are covered by private medical insurance from their first day. Coverage includes the employee's spouse and children under 21. Parents can be added at a discounted employee-paid rate.

6.2 Social insurance

CompanyFlow registers all employees in the national social insurance scheme and pays the employer share.

6.3 Transportation allowance

Employees working on-site receive a monthly transportation allowance of EGP 1,500. Night-shift employees are offered company transport.

6.4 Learning budget

Each employee has a learning budget of EGP 15,000 per year for courses, books and conferences. Unused budget does not carry over.

6.5 Certification reimbursement

CompanyFlow reimburses 100% of the exam fee for job-related certifications (for example Security+, CCNA, PL-300, ITIL) on the first attempt if the employee passes. Employees who leave within 12 months of a reimbursement repay 50% of it.

6.6 Employee referral bonus

Employees who refer a candidate who is hired receive a referral bonus of EGP 10,000, paid after the new hire successfully completes probation. HR staff and the hiring manager for the role are not eligible.

7. Remote and Hybrid Work

7.1 Eligibility

Employees in hybrid roles may work remotely up to 2 days per week after completing probation, with their manager's approval. Shift-based roles are on-site unless stated otherwise in the contract.

7.2 Equipment

CompanyFlow provides a laptop, headset and, on request, a monitor. Company equipment must not be used by family members.

7.3 Working remotely abroad

Working remotely from outside Egypt requires written approval from HR and Information Security and is limited to 10 working days per year.

8. Code of Conduct, Equal Opportunity and Anti-Harassment

8.1 Equal opportunity

CompanyFlow hires, promotes and pays based on job-related merit only. Decisions must never be based on gender, age, religion, disability, marital status, pregnancy, origin or any other protected characteristic.

8.2 Anti-harassment

Harassment of any kind is not tolerated. Report incidents to HR, to your manager, or anonymously through the Speak-Up channel at speakup@companyflow.example. Retaliation against anyone who reports in good faith is a disciplinary offence.

8.3 Conflicts of interest

Declare any outside job, business interest or family relationship with a supplier, candidate or colleague in your reporting line to HR.

8.4 Gifts

Employees may not accept gifts worth more than EGP 1,000 from suppliers or clients.

9. Information Security and Acceptable Use

9.1 Passwords and MFA

Use a unique password of at least 12 characters for company systems. Multi-factor authentication (MFA) is mandatory for email, VPN and the HR portal.

9.2 Reporting phishing and incidents

Report suspicious emails with the "Report Phishing" button in Outlook or by forwarding them to security@companyflow.example. Report a lost laptop or phone to the IT Service Desk within 1 hour.

9.3 Clean desk and screen lock

Lock your screen whenever you leave your desk. Confidential printouts must be stored in locked drawers or shredded.

9.4 Personal devices

Personal devices may access company email only through the approved mobile management app.

10. Data Privacy

10.1 Personal data

CompanyFlow processes employee and candidate personal data only for legitimate HR purposes and in line with the Egyptian Personal Data Protection Law (Law No. 151 of 2020).

10.2 Candidate data retention

Candidate résumés and screening records are kept for 12 months after the hiring decision and then anonymised, unless the candidate consents to a longer retention period.

10.3 Access to HR data

Only authorised HR staff may access candidate and employee records. Every access to candidate data is logged in the HR audit log.

11. Probation and Performance

11.1 Probation period

New employees serve a probation period of 3 months. HR and the manager hold a review meeting before the end of probation.

11.2 Performance reviews

Performance reviews take place twice a year, in June and December. Ratings use a 5-point scale and feed into the January salary review.

11.3 Performance improvement plans

An employee rated "needs improvement" receives a 60-day performance improvement plan with clear goals and weekly check-ins.

12. Training and Development

Every employee has an individual development plan agreed with their manager in the first quarter. Mandatory annual training covers information security awareness, anti-harassment and data privacy.

13. Internal Mobility

Employees may apply for internal vacancies after 12 months in their current role, or earlier with their manager's agreement. Internal candidates are interviewed before external candidates with similar qualifications. Open roles are listed in the CompanyFlow portal.

14. Business Travel and Expenses

14.1 Expense claims

Submit expense claims with receipts in the HR portal within 30 days of the expense. Claims submitted later than 30 days are not reimbursed.

14.2 Travel

Domestic travel is booked through the Admin team. The daily meal allowance for domestic business travel is EGP 600.

15. Resignation and Notice Period

15.1 Notice period

Employees must give written notice before resigning: 1 month for junior employees and 2 months for mid-level, senior and manager-level employees. During probation the notice period is 1 week.

15.2 Exit process

Return all company equipment on your last working day. HR conducts an exit interview and issues the experience certificate within 14 days.

16. Grievances

Raise a grievance with your manager first. If it is not resolved within 10 working days, escalate it in writing to HR, which responds within 15 working days.